08-22 第一篇

The Historical Significance of the Silk Road

The Silk Road was not just a single path but a vast network of trade routes connecting East and West. For over 1,500 years, it served as the main channel for cultural exchange between ancient China and the rest of the world. Caravans carried silk, tea, spices, and precious stones across deserts and mountains. [1] This movement of goods brought more than wealth—it spread ideas, religions, and technologies that shaped human civilization. Without these routes, the world as we know it would be very different.

The Silk Road opened during the Han Dynasty around 200 BC. Emperor Wu sent envoy Zhang Qian westward to form alliances and explore new territories. [2] Zhang Qian's journeys helped map unknown lands and paved the way for steady trade. Later, Marco Polo traveled along similar routes to reach China in the 13th century. His writings opened Europe's eyes to the riches of the East and inspired future explorers.

Along the Silk Road, Buddhism traveled from India to China and Japan. Papermaking and gunpowder spread from China to the Middle East and Europe. [3] These inventions changed how people lived, communicated, and waged war. Glass and grapes came from the West to China. Cultures learned from each other and grew richer through exchange. The road was truly a bridge between civilizations.

The routes passed through harsh deserts, high mountains, and dangerous bandit areas. [4] Travelers faced extreme heat, cold, and lack of water. Despite these challenges, merchants kept the trade alive. They built rest stops and shared knowledge of safe paths. Their courage and persistence made the Silk Road a lasting symbol of human ambition.

[5] Today, the Silk Road spirit lives on. China's Belt and Road Initiative seeks to reconnect nations through trade and cooperation. The ancient routes remind us that peace and exchange, not isolation, lead to progress. Understanding this history helps us build a better future for all.

选项

A. It connected distant peoples and enabled the sharing of culture, knowledge, and inventions across continents. B. His expeditions led to the establishment of regular trade relations between China and Central Asia. C. Science and technology flowed both ways, transforming societies far beyond their origins. D. The journey was full of dangers, yet traders overcame them to keep commerce moving. E. Its legacy continues to inspire modern efforts toward global connectivity and mutual development. F. For example, silk from China was highly valued in Rome, where wealthy people paid high prices for it.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前讲商队运载丝绸、茶叶、香料等货物；空后说“这种物资流动带来的不仅是财富——还传播了思想、宗教和技术”。A项概括了丝绸之路连接各地人民、促成文化知识和技术共享的功能，与前后衔接自然，起承上启下作用。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前介绍张骞西行的背景（汉武帝派遣、结盟与探索）；空后提到马可·波罗沿相似路线到达中国。B项说明张骞的远征促成了中国与中亚之间常规贸易关系的建立，与段内“张骞之旅帮助绘制未知地图并为稳定贸易铺平道路”的表述一致。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前举例佛教、造纸术、火药传播；空后讲玻璃、葡萄传入中国及文化相互学习。C项概括“科学技术双向流动，改变了许多地区的社会”与段落主题句及举例完全吻合。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：空前描述路线途经严酷沙漠、高山和盗匪区；空后写旅行者面临酷暑、严寒和缺水，但商人仍维持贸易。D项强调“旅程充满危险，但商人克服困难保持商业运转”与段落逻辑一致。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：空前为第四段结尾；空后讲“一带一路”及古代路线提醒人们和平与交流带来进步。E项“其遗产继续启发现代追求全球互联互通和共同发展的努力”恰好总结全文并引出当代意义。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, silk from China was highly valued in Rome...**：以For example开头，属具体例子。虽与丝绸之路主题相关，但论述层次停留在单一商品交换层面，无法作为[1]–[5]任一空位的概括性、承递性句子，易误选为[1]或[3]。